

3.2 Population Distribution by Province and District

Sri Lanka's total population is 21,781,800, and its distribution across provinces and districts is presented in Table 3.2.

Table 3.2 : Distribution of Population by Province and District, 2024

Province and District	Population	
	Number	Percentage
Sri Lanka	21,781,800	100.0
Western Province	6,117,341	28.1
Colombo	2,375,415	10.9
Gampaha	2,436,142	11.2
Kalutara	1,305,784	6.0
Central Province	2,714,045	12.5
Kandy	1,461,895	6.7
Matale	526,870	2.4
Nuwara Eliya	725,280	3.3
Southern Province	2,606,679	12.0
Galle	1,097,372	5.0
Matara	837,889	3.8
Hambantota	671,418	3.1
Northern Province	1,150,148	5.3
Jaffna	594,751	2.7
Mannar	123,756	0.6
Vavuniya	172,312	0.8
Mullaitivu	122,619	0.6
Kilinochchi	136,710	0.6
Eastern Province	1,783,214	8.2
Batticaloa	595,918	2.7
Ampara	744,551	3.4
Trincomalee	442,745	2.0
North Western Province	2,586,972	11.9
Kurunegala	1,768,156	8.1
Puttalam	818,816	3.8
North Central Province	1,407,610	6.5
Anuradhapura	960,080	4.4
Polonnaruwa	447,530	2.1
Uva Province	1,399,892	6.4
Badulla	872,307	4.0
Moneragala	527,585	2.4
Sabaragamuwa Province	2,015,899	9.3
Ratnapura	1,145,423	5.3
Kegalle	870,476	4.0

Note: Percentages have been rounded to the nearest one decimal place

When considering the population distribution by province, it is reported that more than one fourth of the total population of the country is from the Western Province, accounting for 28.1 percent. More than 10 percent of the total population is reported from the Central (12.5%), Southern (12.0%), and North Western (11.9%) provinces each. The lowest population is reported from the Northern Province, with 5.3 percent.

Examining the population by district, the highest population is reported from the Gampaha District, which has 2,436,142 persons. The next highest population (2,375,415) is reported from the Colombo District. The district with the lowest population (122,619) is Mullaitivu.